

PERFORMANCE

Performance is something I have never liked on any Oppo Reno smartphone that I have tested in the last few years. The Reno 12 Pro is also the same. We are getting a MediaTek Dimensity 7300 Energy chipset with up to 12GB of RAM. Now, this is a decent chipset and offers enough power to allow you to do as many things as you would normally do on a smartphone, smoothly.

But in perspective to other offerings, it just looks and feels meagre. In benchmark tests, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro falls behind most competitors. Be it in CPU-based benchmarks like AnTuTu or Geekbench, or in GPU-based benchmarks like 3D Mark Wildlife or GFX Bench, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro falls short of rivals.

However, this is not about performance. The Oppo Reno series of smartphones has never been about that. It is about the experience. The camera, the AI features this year, the look and feel - that's what the Oppo Reno 12 Pro is about and for those purposes, the MediaTek Dimensity 7300 Extra is enough. But still, it doesn't justify having a similar chipset as on sub-Rs 20,000 phones. For example, the Nothing CMF Phone 1, which was launched earlier this week also comes with a Dimensity 7300 chipset. That phone is priced around Rs 15,000!

But well, in my day-to-day usage which included social media, using the camera, and trying out Oppo's AI features, the Reno 12 Pro had no issues with its performance. In gaming, however, it didn't feel very premium and smooth. It did run all the games, but I did experience some or the other issues like heating or frame drops.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

Now, this is another area where the Oppo Reno 12 Pro performed really well. The battery on the smartphone is a 5,000mAh unit with support for 80W fast charging. Now, the battery backup is good. In my video loop test, where I run a 4K video on loop until the phone dies, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro lasted more

than 16 hours (973 minutes). Furthermore, playing Call of Duty: Mobile for 15 minutes only drained the smartphone's battery by just 3 percent. Watching a YouTube video for 30 minutes drained 5 percent of the battery, and GPS navigation for 1 hour drained 6 percent of the Oppo Reno 12 Pro's battery.

Coming to charging, the 80W fast charging took 49 minutes to charge the Oppo Reno 12 Pro from 0 to 100 percent. This isn't the fastest 80W we have seen but a charging time of less than 50 minutes is more than enough for any kind of user.

CAMERA

On to the Oppo Reno 12 Pro's strong-point, the camera. Here, we are getting a triple rear camera setup with a 50-megapixel primary shooter, a 50-megapixel telephoto lens, and an 8-megapixel ultrawide angle lens. The photos out of this camera are good. There is no lack of sharpness and the colours are nice and vibrant on the Oppo Reno 12 Pro from the primary shooter.

The ultrawide angle lens on the smartphone isn't of the best quality and despite Oppo's tuning, you can see that the Sony IMX355 shooter just doesn't match up to the quality and sharpness of the primary shooter, leading to inconsistent results between the two lenses.

The telephoto shooter is good quality. We get 2x optical and 5x in-sensor zoom with the telephoto shooter. Now, the optical zoom is as good as the 1x shots from this smartphone. With 5x also, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro is able to retain a lot of details, but you can clearly tell that it's not as good as optical zoom.

In low light also, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro's camera performed fairly well. I did experience a lot of light flare in low light shots, but at times, that does add to the aesthetic as well. In very low light, however, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro loses details quite evidently. But if there is even a little bit of light, the quality of the photos are retained well.

Coming to portraits, this is where the Oppo Reno series has always performed well, and the Oppo Reno 12

Pro's portraits are in-line with my past experiences with the device. The smartphone does a very good job in terms of identifying and singling out the subject, but the edge detection is very aggressive at times, which can be set to a lower aperture level so not an issue.

The one thing I noticed about the Oppo Reno 12 Pro's camera is that the colours are more towards the vibrant or saturated side. Now, this is not all that bad but at times the colours look a bit too blown up or artificial, but then again, this is something that many people want with their cameras.

VERDICT

So the Oppo Reno 12 Pro is made for the offline customers. There isn't much to appeal to an enthusiast like myself, but there is a lot that will appeal to a lot of people in India. The bling, the saturated floating display, and the camera - all are things that have appealed to the offline buyers of the Oppo Reno series, and in this sense, the Oppo Reno 12 Pro does offer the same in a new style and with newer AI features to keep up with the trend.

So yes, outside of the enthusiast lens, I was able to make sense of the Oppo Reno 12 Pro despite its shortcomings. But still, there are things that make this one of the least appealing smartphones in this range. The biggest competitor to this device is obviously the Vivo V30 Pro and if we are talking about the overall experience, I would still recommend the Vivo over the Oppo Reno 12 Pro, even for our offline buyer friends out there.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: MediaTek Dimensity 7300 Energy | GPU: Mali-G615 MC2 | OS: ColorOS 14.1 based on Android 14 | Display: 6.7-inch FHD+ AMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz | RAM: Up to 12GB | ROM: Up to 256GB | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 50MP + 8MP | Cameras (front): 50MP | Battery: 5000mAh | Charging: 80W

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